What makes a multimedia service complete

- A useful resource connects a real audience need to suitable images, audio, video and text.
- Production alone is incomplete without accurate metadata, access decisions and user testing.
- The same resource must be discoverable, usable, reliable, maintainable and responsibly published.

TAKEAWAY **Success is a usable information service, not merely a polished poster.**

From idea to published service

- Begin with a problem statement, user needs, scope, a media inventory and measurable outcomes.
- Design the content and navigation; produce accessible assets; review rights and metadata.
- Test with users, repair defects, document approval, publish and monitor the released version.

TAKEAWAY Publication is a controlled lifecycle, not the final button click.

Two professional directions

- BLISS: develop a digital-library guide or public exhibition that helps readers discover collections.
- BRIM: build an archival exhibition or records guide that protects provenance and restricted items.
- Both groups use the same technical checks while selecting different professional contexts.

TAKEAWAY Shared multimedia skills support different information professions.

Define a clear service problem

- A useful brief names who is struggling, what task they cannot complete and what would improve.
- Example BLISS: first-time students cannot locate the institutional e-resource tutorial.
- Example BRIM: researchers cannot identify which archival interview is publicly accessible.

TAKEAWAY A purpose statement should describe an observable user problem.

Personas and authentic user tasks

- A persona describes a relevant user group, device limitations, access needs and goals.
- Turn the persona into tasks such as “find and open the digitised exhibition item”.
- Consider mobile data costs, language, keyboard-only navigation and limited prior knowledge.

TAKEAWAY Design for realistic tasks, not a hypothetical perfect user.

Scope and success criteria

- Define the minimum useful project: three or more items, clear navigation and tested access.
- Record exclusions so project complexity stays manageable within the teaching timetable.
- Success criteria might include accurate metadata and completing a task without assistance.

TAKEAWAY Choose evidence that can confirm or disprove success.

Information architecture

- Group content into understandable sections with meaningful headings and link labels.
- A simple small-site structure can use Home, Collections, Item Details, About and Help.
- Avoid duplicate paths that send users into dead ends or hide the return route.

TAKEAWAY Good navigation makes a collection understandable.

A four-screen prototype

- Home explains the collection purpose; Browse lists public records; Item opens one description.
- Help explains access rules, citation and feedback, with clear return navigation.
- Restricted items can have safe metadata without publishing the restricted source file.

TAKEAWAY **Every screen should support a defined user task.**

Responsive, low-bandwidth delivery

- Ensure content reflows on phone-sized displays without horizontal page scrolling.
- Provide appropriately sized images, captions, transcripts and alternatives to large media.
- Test a slow connection and provide meaningful feedback when files cannot load.

TAKEAWAY Technical delivery choices influence real access.

Item-level discovery fields

- Useful descriptive fields include title, creator or originating body, date, type and identifier.
- Include subject, description, rights and source or collection relationship when appropriate.
- Consistent fields improve both searching and long-term interpretation.

TAKEAWAY **Metadata should support a real discovery task.**

Search and browse design

- Provide sensible collection categories and search terms users are likely to enter.
- Check misspellings, synonyms and empty-result messages with realistic examples.
- Do not disclose restricted personal information in titles, snippets or filenames.

TAKEAWAY A search result must be both relevant and safe.

Source–derivative links and versions

- Give each resource a stable local identifier and preserve links between related files.
- Record revisions so captions, descriptions and publication permissions remain auditable.
- A published version should be distinguishable from a later corrected version.

TAKEAWAY **Version history supports trust and maintenance.**

Accessible media alternatives

- Give meaningful images appropriate alt text and give speech video synchronised captions.
- Provide transcripts for audio and include significant visual information where necessary.
- Test with actual content; automated checks do not establish complete accessibility.

TAKEAWAY Alternatives must communicate useful information.

Keyboard, focus and contrast

- Reach navigation, cards and buttons using Tab/Shift+Tab and activate them without a mouse.
- Confirm visible keyboard focus, clear labels and adequate text/background contrast.
- Check a mobile layout at high zoom and review reading order.

TAKEAWAY Accessibility is a tested property of the delivered experience.

Inclusive language and respectful representation

- Use plain language, accurate names, context and inclusive descriptions.
- Avoid unverified historical identities, stereotypes and invasive personal details.
- Make language alternatives possible when the audience requires them.

TAKEAWAY **Respect and accuracy belong in the design specification.**

Quality assurance versus final checks

- Quality assurance defines a repeatable process that prevents mistakes throughout production.
- Quality control examines actual deliverables: links, text, formats, playback and metadata.
- A final gate checks readiness, but does not replace ongoing QA practices.

TAKEAWAY **Prevent defects early and verify the release copy.**

A publication readiness checklist

- Check content accuracy, rights, privacy, accessibility, file integrity and working links.
- Confirm user tasks, suitable performance, versioning, backup and approved access decisions.
- Record evidence and unresolved issues alongside the authorised reviewer.

TAKEAWAY A tick box records a claim; supporting evidence makes it credible.

Release decisions and unresolved risks

- Classify each issue by impact, likelihood, responsibility and realistic remedy.
- Block publication of restricted files and critical accessibility barriers until addressed.
- A low-impact cosmetic defect may be tracked for later repair with documented approval.

TAKEAWAY **Not every problem has equal consequences.**

Purpose of usability evaluation

- Usability measures whether representative users can achieve intended tasks effectively.
- Observe behaviour rather than asking only if participants “like the design”.
- Use task completion, errors, navigation difficulty and participant comments together.

TAKEAWAY **Evaluate the service against the user’s work.**

Task-based testing protocol

- State a neutral task, give the participant a realistic starting page and observe without coaching.
- Record success, time, errors, assistance needed and the participant’s explanation.
- Use fictional records in classroom tests; obtain appropriate consent for research involving people.

TAKEAWAY A reproducible protocol gives meaning to test evidence.

Task completion and limits

- Completion rate = successful task attempts / total valid attempts × 100%.
- Example: 8 successes out of 10 attempts gives an observed completion rate of 80%.
- Small classroom samples show possible defects; they do not establish population-wide performance.

TAKEAWAY Numbers need context, definitions and limitations.

Evidence beyond a percentage

- A task can be completed but still be confusing, slow or dependent on assistance.
- Examine observation notes and distinguish minor hesitation from critical task failure.
- Avoid overgeneralising from a few classmates who already know the system.

TAKEAWAY Combine quantitative and qualitative evidence.

Prioritising defects for repair

- High-impact broken navigation and privacy exposures receive urgent attention.
- Use an impact–effort matrix, but let safety and access restrictions override simple convenience scores.
- Assign each issue an owner, action, retest date and closure evidence.

TAKEAWAY Improvement requires accountability, not only a defect list.

Evaluate again after changes

- Re-run the same key tasks after repairing navigation, media captions or search.
- Compare outcomes while noting changes in test participants and conditions.
- Keep a test log and a versioned changelog so improvements can be traced.

TAKEAWAY Testing should lead to a documented improvement cycle.

A practical GitHub Pages release

- Use a static site with index.html and self-contained assets for a simple classroom prototype.
- Check file paths and case-sensitive names, especially after uploading from Windows.
- Keep real credentials, private records and lecturer-only assessments out of public repositories.

TAKEAWAY A public repository is a publication channel, not restricted storage.

Release package and documentation

- Provide a readable README, navigation instructions, project credits and source records.
- Include a media manifest, rights register, accessibility test log and version history.
- Build a reproducible package so another student or staff member can inspect the output.

TAKEAWAY Documentation is part of the deliverable.

Continuity after release

- Plan who corrects inaccurate descriptions, checks broken links and handles requests for removal.
- Maintain backed-up originals, verified access copies and a documented revision route.
- Review permission expiry, format changes and accessibility defects periodically.

TAKEAWAY A publication creates ongoing responsibilities.

BLISS project brief

- Create an accessible digital library orientation or small themed exhibition using fictional or licensed assets.
- Include at least three discoverable items, a meaningful image, an audio/video element and descriptions.
- Provide appropriate credits, captions/transcripts, alt text and a tested user task.

TAKEAWAY Design for real library users, including mobile visitors.

BLISS walkthrough

- A student visits Home, browses the cultural collection, reads an item and plays an orientation clip.
- They can return to Browse, find a second record and understand how to cite the content.
- A task observer records where navigation and metadata help or obstruct the task.

TAKEAWAY The project succeeds when information can be found and understood.

BLISS assessment evidence

- Submit source and derivative inventory, metadata, permissions, accessibility checks and test observations.
- Include screenshots of the working site, a concise reflection and a repair log.
- Do not substitute an attractive home page for a working and documented user journey.

TAKEAWAY Show the finished service and evidence of its quality.

BRIM project brief

- Create a fictional archival exhibition or records-access guide with provenance and controlled access.
- Include at least three described items, one restricted example and a safe public descriptive record.
- Connect source–derivative relationships, rights information and authorised access conditions.

TAKEAWAY **Protect evidential context while explaining discovery.**

BRIM walkthrough

- A researcher browses collections, inspects a public catalogue record and reads an access notice.
- Restricted audio is not linked publicly; a safe summary explains the request route.
- The tester checks whether source context, identifiers and access rules are understandable.

TAKEAWAY **Good archival access avoids both concealment and unsafe disclosure.**

BRIM assessment evidence

- Provide description and provenance records, a restriction rationale and versioned file inventory.
- Document checks for access control, metadata consistency, captions, safe derivatives and usability.
- Use fictional data, never actual confidential institutional records in the public demo.

TAKEAWAY A trustworthy interface preserves meaning and control.

An effective demonstration

- Explain the problem and user group, then demonstrate a complete user task end to end.
- Show one design choice, one test result and one correction rather than listing features only.
- Keep the demonstration truthful; distinguish working features from planned future work.

TAKEAWAY A strong presentation proves the resource is usable.

What makes a strong project?

- A strong project shows clear purpose and scope, suitable media, helpful metadata, usable navigation, accessibility, rights checks and test results.
- A justified restricted-access decision may be more responsible than publishing sensitive content.
- BLISS and BRIM projects use the same quality principles in different professional settings.

TAKEAWAY **Assess demonstrated skills, not only appearance.**

Final course synthesis

- Units 1–6 supplied multimedia creation and delivery skills; Units 7–9 added interaction and description.
- Units 10–11 added preservation, legal and ethical responsibilities; Unit 12 integrates them.
- The outcome is a responsibly published, accessible and tested information resource.

TAKEAWAY Plan, create, describe, protect, publish, evaluate and improve.